Faculty Appointment Start-Up Guidelines

Introduction

This document provides university-wide guidelines for coordinating administrative, operational, and compliance activities associated with initiating a new research-track faculty appointment. It is intended for college administrators, department staff, HR partners, and central service units supporting faculty transitions. The guidance standardizes roles, timing, and required documentation to ensure consistent execution across colleges. Local practices may supplement these guidelines where they do not conflict with university policy.

Appointment Coordination and Handoff

After the hiring packet has been initiated and FOP-1 has been completed and submitted to route core hiring details to HR, Payroll, IT, and the dean's office, the department administrator finalizes appointment setup by completing the Position Data Form (PDF-7). Using the onboarding toolkit or the EastportWorks attachments area, the coordinator opens PDF-7, records the onboarding case ID and faculty member's name, and selects the appropriate job code and job title aligned to the approved appointment. The form must capture the faculty rank and track, the appointment FTE percentage, and the correct pay basis (e.g., academic-year versus fiscal-year cycle and the applicable exempt/salaried designation) to ensure downstream payroll and benefits configuration is accurate. Compensation rate fields required by the form are entered based on the signed offer terms, and the effective/start date is cross-checked to match the offer letter to prevent retroactive pay corrections or contract compliance issues. Once validated, PDF-7 is saved in the case file and prepared for routing so that HR and Payroll can complete system entry and confirm appointment activation without delays.

Conclusion

Consistent execution of these guidelines reduces delays, minimizes risk, and improves the new faculty member's experience during their transition to Eastport University. Clear handoffs between departments, colleges, and central units help ensure that critical approvals, access, and resources are in place when needed. Adhering to standardized steps supports audit readiness, equitable treatment across colleges, and timely activation of research activity. Units should review these procedures annually and update local checklists to reflect policy or system changes.